

Gender roles in physics

It's so much better than it used to be!!!!

We've made such progress in recent years. Sexism/racism/discrimination is no longer as obvious (sometimes it is, but in general it's much better).

However, the problem has not yet been solved.

Without us wanting it to be, sexism and racism are part of us, because we have all grown up in a society that is racist and sexist.

This still has a strong impact on everyday life

- Care work, emotional responsibility for
 - One's own feelings
 - Family and friends
 - Mood in a room
 - For your partner (in heterosexual relationships)
 - Mans planning
 - Being taken seriously
 - The feeling to be safe
- For men:
- Lack of access to feelings
 - Dealing with feelings
 - Showing vulnerability
 - Asking for help: Suicide rates men vs women

Where it is still noticeable in well-functioning working groups in physics:

- Emotional responsibility:
 - Organizing working group meetings/events
 - Supervising bachelor's/master's students
 - Outreach
 - Science communication is the care work of physics
- Impostor syndrome:
 - Experience: "In reality, I'm not good enough, so I have to constantly prove that I am good enough ""
 - "In reality, I'm not smart enough/ qualified- I am just pretending and I am afraid that people will notice."
- No place for average women in physics?

- "Women can't do physics", so if you do physics, you're different from other women
- "What's it like being a woman in physics?" frequently ask question
- Experience: Am I weird because I do physics as a woman?
- Experience in highschool: I am "the woman" who does physics.
 - The feeling that there is actually only room for one women

If a man wants to present the idea:

- I can't imagine what it feels like to be a woman in physics.
- That's why I'm not the best person to start here, and I don't know how much it will help.
- But I would like to offer it to you in this context, because it
 - Solidarity among women
 - Connect with each other, talk about your experiences
 - Sometimes you don't notice certain things until you talk to other people about them and share your experiences.
- But you also don't have to talk about it.
 - I know that women are forced to think and talk about this stuff anyway,
 - I just wanted to offer a platform in case you are interested
- You are not alone, and I want to continue working with you to move forward.